Tenure-Track Faculty Appointment Operations Guide

Introduction

This document provides operational guidelines for activating and supporting tenure-track faculty appointments across Eastport University. It establishes consistent coordination among Academic Affairs, HR, Payroll, IT, and college administrative units. The guidance is designed to reduce delays, ensure compliance, and create a standardized experience across colleges. These procedures apply to newly hired research-track faculty and the staff responsible for their appointment execution.

Appointment Activation and Start-Date Coordination

Appointment activation at Eastport University begins once access needs are validated: when specialized lab or controlled spaces are required, the department must submit the Lab/Space Access Request (LAR-5) and ensure appropriate EH&S trainings are assigned before any lab credentials are issued; otherwise, standard office access may be provisioned. If the faculty member will teach in the first term, the department administrator coordinates with Academic Affairs/Registrar to confirm the Instructor-of-Record designation is entered for the correct course sections and that the hire's LMS account and course shells are available and tested prior to the start date. As part of compliance onboarding, the new faculty member must complete the annual Conflict of Interest disclosure through the ERIC portal, and the onboarding coordinator records and verifies submission status in the case file. To ensure early performance support and issue escalation, HR schedules structured 30/60/90-day check-ins with the department (and includes ISSS in the cadence when an immigration/sponsorship case exists), with each meeting date and responsible owner documented. These steps collectively align teaching readiness, access controls, and compliance obligations with the start-date timeline, reducing term-start disruptions and audit risk.

Conclusion

Consistent execution of these guidelines enables timely appointment activation and reduces operational risk for the university. Adhering to defined roles, approvals, and documentation standards supports audit readiness and policy compliance. Coordinated planning across central offices and colleges improves service quality for new faculty and their departments. Units should use this guide as the baseline reference and escalate exceptions through established governance channels.